

Guitar Basics

1. Parts of the Guitar

- **Headstock:** Located at the top of the neck. It holds the tuning pegs.
- **Tuning Pegs:** Knobs used to adjust the pitch of each string to get in tune.
- **Nut:** The small piece where the headstock meets the neck that holds the strings in place.
- **Neck:** The long piece of wood where your fretting hand sits.
- **Fretboard & Frets:** The front surface of the neck. Metal strips called **frets** divide the fretboard into sections. Pressing a string against a fret changes its pitch.
- **Body:** The large main part of the guitar. On an acoustic, it amplifies the sound naturally through the soundhole. On an electric, it houses the pickups and volume knobs.
- **Bridge:** Located on the body, holding the opposite end of the strings securely.

2. How to Hold the Guitar Correctly

1. **Body Position:** Sit up straight in a comfortable chair without arms. Rest the curve of the guitar body on your right thigh (if right-handed).
2. **Body Alignment:** Pull the back of the guitar close to your chest, keeping it upright rather than tilted upward toward your face.
3. **Fretting Hand Placement:** Place your thumb against the back of the neck for leverage, keeping your wrist slightly bent. Use the tips of your fingers to press down on strings rather than the flat pads.
4. **Strumming Hand:** Rest your right forearm on the upper edge of the guitar body, allowing your wrist to remain relaxed over the strings or soundhole.

3. Guitar String Names

Standard guitars have 6 strings, numbered **1 through 6** starting from the thinnest (lowest in height) to the thickest (highest in height).

- **String 6 (Thickest / Lowest Pitch): E**
- **String 5: A**
- **String 4: D**
- **String 3: G**
- **String 2: B**
- **String 1 (Thinnest / Highest Pitch): E**

Memory Trick: To easily remember the order from 6th to 1st string (**E - A - D - G - B - E**), use a standard mnemonic:

- Every Address Does Get Box Everyday
- Eddie Ate Dynamite, GoodBye Eddie

